

FIRST CONGREGATIONAL CHURCH
of Los Angeles

Pentecost 4
Another Kind of Freedom ~
Anchored in Hope

28 June 2026



Sunset Boats on the Shore, 1910
Trush Ivan Ivanovych, Ukraine

540 S. Commonwealth Avenue, Los Angeles, California 90020
Telephone 213.385.1341 – www.FCCLA.org

The Gathering of the People

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles is a safe place for all people, and we celebrate our diversity of race, creed, age, ability, gender, religion, cultural background, sexual orientation, gender identities and expressions... We extend a warm welcome to all this morning and especially those who are with us for the first time. Your presence both enriches us and this time of celebration together ~

Please note that our services are live streamed at fccla.org/live.

Organ Prelude Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, Organist-in-Residence

Improvisation on RAQUEL and HYFRYDOL

Four Short Preludes and Fugues ascribed to Bach - Part II:

- Prelude and Fugue in G, BWV 557
- Prelude and Fugue in g, BWV 558
- Prelude and Fugue in a, BWV 559
- Prelude and Fugue in Bb, BWV 560

Chiming of the Hour

Welcome

Rev. Michael Lehman

Words of Gathering

Danielle Vigent & Greta Langenberg

When hope invites us to journey,
elusive, beckoning onward
but never in our grasp:
*God of wisdom and promise,
give us courage to travel on.*

When dreams glimmer in the distance,
fading, clouded, and hidden
or shining with new brightness:
*God of wisdom and promise,
give us courage to travel on.*

When established patterns collapse
into the uncertainty of the unknown
and security dissolves into a memory:
*God of wisdom and promise,
give us courage to travel on.*

When the illusion of success
threatens to divert us
and silence our souls' yearning:
*God of wisdom and promise,
give us courage to travel on.*

When we think our journey has ended
only to find the end is a new beginning:
*God of wisdom and promise,
give us courage to travel on.*

[JBerry/ssb]

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

***Hymn of Gathering**

Let Us Hope

HYFRYDOL

Let us hope when hope seems hopeless,
When the dreams we dreamed have died.
When the morning breaks in brightness,
Hunger shall be satisfied.
One who sows the fields with weeping
Shall retrace the sorrowing way
And rejoice in harvest bounty
At the breaking of the day.

Faith and hope in love's compassion
Will survive though knowledge cease,
Through the tongues of joy fall silent,
Dull the words of prophecies.
Faith shall see and trust its object;
Hope shall set the anchor sure;
Love shall bloom in Love eternal.
Faith and hope and love endure.

Like a child outgrowing childhood,
Setting childhood things away,
We will learn to live in freedom,
In the life of God's new day.
Now we see as in a mirror.
Then we shall see face to face,
Understand how love's compassion
Blossoms through amazing Grace.
--lyrics by E.L.Diemer

***Prayer of Awareness**

Rev. Lehman

Anchoring Presence, Ground of All Being,
in a world of constant upheaval, how easily we drift into despair.
Thank you for promising to hold us secure
not in human institutions or efforts alone,
but in your very presence.

When the storms of violence, injustice, and fear
threaten to overwhelm us,
help us feel the steady pull of your faithfulness.
Make us people whose anchored hope
offers stability to others amid fear and cynicism.

In name of the One who goes with us through every storm,
Amen and Amen.

***Introit**

“Land Of Hopes And Dreams”
Laude, David Harris, *Soloist*

BRUCE SPRINGSTEEN,
arr. DAVID HARRIS

***The Lord’s Prayer**

Danielle Vigent

*Creator of us all,
who dwells within and beyond,
Sacred is your name.
May your holy vision for collective flourishing
come to fruition among us.
May your dreams of justice, love, compassion, and
connection be enfleshed on earth.
Provide us today with what we need to be nourished
in body, soul, and heart.
Forgive us for the harm we cause as we seek to
forgive those who have harmed us.
Lead us away from everything that destroys and
liberate us from the hands of evil.
For you are the ultimate source of hope.
Your power-with exceeds all power-over.
Your presence incites eternal wonder.
All praise to you, our comfort and our strength.
Amen and Amen!*

[enfleshed/adpt/lvf]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

***Passing of the Peace**

Rev. Chad Tanaka Pack

Give us your power and peace,
in anger and mistrust:
Give us power and peace, loving God.

Give us power and peace,
in pain and brokenness:
Give us power and peace, healing God.

Give us power and peace,
from division and conflict:
Give us your power and peace, reconciling God.

Give us power and peace,
amid violence and injustice:
Give us your power and peace, gentle God.

Welcoming God, on this day,
come and renew us,
and grant us, and your world, power and peace.

May the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

Reading from Our Religious Tradition

Greta Langenberg

from the Letter of Hebrews

For this witness of the ancestors,
Thanks be to God!

Prayers with the People

Rev. Tanaka Pack

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Silence

Prayer of Our Hearts

Holy One,
Light of all healing:
Be present with us.
Rooted in your love,
May we be.
Filled with your peace,
May we be.
Illumined by your grace,
May we be.

Kindle our hearts
into quiet strength.
Calm our spirits
into restoration.

*Then, O God,
restore the hope and joy of our hearts,
and the hearts of all people,
on this day - and in all the days to come.*

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!
Amen and Amen.

Meditation Anthem

“River”
Lorenzo Zapata, *Soloist*, and Laude

LEON BRIDGES, JOSHUA ALAN BLOCK,
AUSTIN JENKINS, & CHRISTOPHER VIVION

Sermon

Anchored in Hope

Rev. Lehman

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

Prayer of Blessing

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

Invitation to Generosity

Danielle Vigent

Each week as we gather in this sacred time,
we are each wrapped in the unfolding of life
as we co-create the future with each other –
and with our God.

Our stories are a part of the greater whole,
one that transcends time
and connects us across the ages,
through the love of God we have found
for each one of us.

On this day, may we offer ourselves,
our gifts, and our personal commitments
for the sake of those who went before us,
for those yet to come,
and for the One whose life binds us together.

At First Church, we consider every pledge, tithe, offering and contribution a gift for the life of our community of faith. No matter how they're given, our gifts show gratitude. You are invited to visit our website at fccla.org/give. Our hospitality team will also bring baskets for your in-person gifts during the Offertory.

Offertory

"Hope Lingers On"
Cathedral Choir

ANDREA RAMSEY

*Doxology

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

*Offering Prayer

Greta Langenberg

Holy One of Many Names,
may these gifts be used
to bring comfort and courage,

hope and love,
to all your children.

And we may work, O God,
to end the violence and suffering
that plague your many children
in our country and around the world.

On this day, may we work
for peace,
and may our prayers be not only on our lips,
but in our lives.

May it be so.
May it ever be so for all of us.
Amen and Amen.

Please be seated

Life at First Church

Rev. Lehman

Words of Blessing

Rev. Lehman

So may we know
the hope
that is not just
for someday
but for this day—
here, now,
in this moment
that opens to us:

*hope not made
of wishes
but of substance,*

hope made of sinew
and muscle
and bone,

*hope that has breath
and a beating heart,*

hope that will not
keep quiet
and be polite,

*hope that knows
how to holler
when it is called for,*

hope that knows
how to sing
when there seems
little cause,

*hope that raises us
from death to life—
not someday
but this day,
every day,
again and
again and
again!*

Choral Response

“No nos moverán” SPIRITUAL AND FARM WORKER PROTEST SONG
Cathedral Choir

“We shall not be moved! Just like a tree that’s planted by the water, we shall not be moved!”

*Hymn for the Journey

Womb of Life, and Source of Being

RAQUEL

Womb of life, and source of being, home of every restless heart,
In your arms the worlds awakened, you have loved us from the start.
We, your children, gather ‘round you, at the table you prepare.
Sharing stories, tears, and laughter, we are nurtured by your care.

Word in flesh, our brother Jesus, born to bring us, second birth,
You have come to stand beside us, knowing weakness, knowing earth.
Priest who share our human struggles, Life of Life, and Death of Death,
Risen Christ come stand among us, send the Spirit by your breath.

Brooding Spirit, move among us, be our partner, be our friend.
When our mem-’ry fails, remind us whose we are and what we intend.
Labor with us, add the birthing of the new world yet to be,
Free of servants, lord, and master, free for love and unity.

Mother, Brother, holy Partner, Father, Spirit, Only Son:
We would praise your name forever, one-in-three, and three-in-one.
We would share your life, your passion, share your word of world made new,
Ever singing, ever praising, one with all, and one with you.

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*
Short Prelude in Bb ascribed to Bach, BWV 560/1 - Reprise

Inside The Music

Dr. David Harris

“Here in the week between our two national freedom holidays, the theme of hope feels important. One of the reasons I remain dedicated to the arts has to do with the power of culture to slowly massage the minds and hearts of people toward paths of potential. Bruce Springsteen launched his “Land Of Hopes And Dreams” tour as a hopeful reminder that the arts can stir us, bring us together, and even provide direction. I’ve wanted to sing this song for years, and it finally feels like an essential moment. In his man of the people way, Springsteen gives us a map for who we are as a people. We are resilient, dedicated to

one another, we're moving, and there's room for everyone. Leon Bridges brings us a complicated message of hope. From places of ruin, "River," begs us to shed the fears and tarnished edges of yesterday. It's a sermon to the self, a call to cast out shame and welcome in love. Ramsey's "Hope Lingers On" reminds us that our strength flows from compassion. When it's hard to understand the snares of the world, we can commit to hope by insisting upon love over hate, joy over fear. We end with a multi-cultural American justice creation. "No nos moverán" was originally the spiritual "We Shall Not Be Moved." It became popular in the Farm Workers Movement when translated into Spanish. If there is one hope in this nation and world it is that we have more in common than what separates us. Freedom begins within the self, perhaps, and flows toward the common good of all people through compassion's deep justice."